

EXPLOITATION, MODERN SLAVERY & TRAFFICKING – TYPES & INDICATORS



Exploitation is the use of an imbalance of power to coerce and manipulate individuals or groups into activity for financial or social gain – exploiters may use resources such as money, documents, substances, shelter or even the promise of company to create this power imbalance or they may use violence, or threats of violence against the individual or their family and friends

Modern Day Slavery is a specific type of exploitation that is covered by the Modern-Day Slavery Act ([Modern Slavery Act 2015 - GOV.UK](#))

TYPES OF EXPLOITATION

① SEXUAL EXPLOITATION

Victims are groomed or forced into sex work or performing sexual acts, often for little or no pay, and face threats and violence. This can occur in brothels, on the street, or through individual exploiters.

② FORCED LABOUR

Vulnerable people are exploited to work for little or no pay, often in dangerous conditions and living in squalor. They may face violence, threats, and have their passports confiscated.

③ DOMESTIC SERVITUDE

Victims work continuously in private households with restricted freedoms, often for little or no pay, and endure harsh conditions. There are sometimes links to forced marriage.

④ CRIMINAL EXPLOITATION

Individuals or groups are controlled and forced to commit crimes against their will, including gang and drug-related activities, forced begging, shoplifting, benefit fraud, and theft. Sham and forced marriages, often involving domestic abuse, also fall under this category. Victims may be coerced into various illegal activities such as pickpocketing, shoplifting, cannabis cultivation, and county lines exploitation.

⑤ TRAFFICKING

A type of exploitation whereby a person or people are harboured or moved from one location to another for the purposes of exploitation – it's often thought that trafficking occurs between countries, but it can occur from place to place within the same town.

⑥ CUCKOOING

Cuckooing is a type of criminal exploitation that involves an individual or group of individuals taking over the home of a vulnerable individual for the purposes of criminality (manufacture and distribution of substances, cannabis cultivation, storing stolen goods etc).

INDICATORS OF EXPLOITATION



PHYSICAL

Signs of injury (bruising, scarring, burn marks etc) these may be both old and new- may be unable to explain how these occurred, branding (this is more common in sexual exploitation), malnutrition, unkempt appearance, lack of appropriate clothing (consider work appropriate clothing, i.e. PPE), appears withdrawn, fearful, lack of access to medical care.



OTHER INDICATORS

No ID or other documents, appears under the control of others- others may speak on their behalf, may appear fearful of or aggressive towards authorities, dropped off and collected late at night/ early in the morning, work long hours, lack of local knowledge- (i.e. address, how to get to the shops, geographical location), may change story or repeat the same well-rehearsed story, lack freedom of movement, limited vocabulary- may be limited to e.g. sexualised words.



ENVIRONMENTAL

Poor property conditions, may live and work at the same location, lack of personal possessions, 'hot bedding' (where a single bedspace is shared amongst several individuals in 'shifts'), associated ASB, (this may be seen in cuckooed properties- high footfall, parties etc), large amounts of rubbish (indication of overcrowding).



VULNERABILITIES

Exploitation can happen to anyone, there is no victim 'type' however, there are factors that may make someone more vulnerable to exploitation, such as – loneliness, substance use, poor mental health, financial issues, insecure immigration status, insecure housing, lack of support network. It's important to note that individuals may not always present as victims or even recognise themselves as such. Exploitation can be subtle and manipulative, making it difficult for victims to identify their situation. They might appear to be coping well or even willingly participating in exploitative activities.

REMEMBER - The mechanism of power and control are so formidable that the activity can appear consensual even when it isn't there are many barriers that will prevent victims seeking or engaging with help and support. Concerns are often hidden, therefore if you see something that concerns you, or just get a sense that something is amiss, it's vital that you act, it may be that you are the only professional to have contact with that individual and your actions matter.

WHAT'S NEXT?

If someone is in immediate danger, always call 999 for police/ emergency services. 101 or 'live chat' can be used for non-emergencies

Social care can be contacted if there are indications of care and support needs

The Local Authority Slavery Exploitation Team can be contacted for referrals/ advice at MSVP@nottinghamcity.gov.uk (for City and County professionals)